

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

1Q26 Earnings Review: Asset quality overhang lifting, but execution remains key on wealth for re-rating

UOBH.SI

12m Price Target: **S\$41.70**Price: **S\$36.70**Upside: **13.6%**

UOB posted 1Q26 net profit of S\$1,437mn, -4% yoy/+2% qoq, +0% vs. GSe (see [First Take: Inline with weak PPOP offset by lower credit cost](#)).

Our Take: UOB delivered modest earnings beat (+2%) relative to consensus expectations in its 1Q26 result released today (+0% vs GSe). Following the headline beat and also lower NPA formation this quarter its share price opened higher at +0.5% against yesterday's close (vs. STI at +0.6%), however it has since drifted lower and closed at +0.14% (vs. STI at 0.3%). With the **narrative on CRE exposure being an overhang** for the stock (shares are +8% in past 6m vs SG peers of +15%), we think the lower new NPA formation along with credit costs coming within FY26 guidance (25-30bps) will alleviate this overhang. That said, the stock still underperformed peers today given its weak wealth fees showing and also with more muted deposit growth. Wealth is a big structural growth for the banks in this region and has a strong support for earnings growth. The weak fees and AUM growth this quarter is a disappointment. That said on the positive side, management has a longer-term ambition to scale wealth income by 2030, aligning with a broader regional investor preference for more capital-light, fee-driven business models amid structural liquidity inflows. That said, these **positives remain early-stage**, and we expect the market to **stay selective**, with investors likely needing to see **(1)** more consecutive "clean" quarters with no additional CRE downgrades, **(2)** clearer evidence of re acceleration in wealth momentum relative to peers, and **(3)** how effectively management translates its balance-sheet strength into earnings delivery if surplus liquidity conditions persist, **before a meaningful re-rating materialises**.

With this in mind, we maintain our **Neutral rating**. Post results, we revise our 2026-28 net income estimates by **+2.3%/+0.1%/+0.2%** as we bake in higher NIM and lower credit cost in 1Q26. Our 2 stage DDM 12-month target price is revised up to **S\$41.7** from S\$41.5.

NEUTRAL

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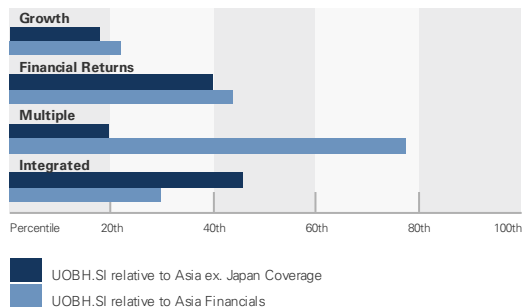
Key Data

Market cap: S\$61.4bn / \$48.4bn
3m ADTV: S\$115.4mn / \$90.6mn
Singapore
Asia Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	4,681.0	5,593.1	5,869.3	6,176.0
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	4,681.0	5,434.6	5,824.6	6,123.9
EPS (S\$) New	2.73	3.27	3.44	3.62
EPS (S\$) Old	2.73	3.18	3.41	3.59
EPS growth (%)	(22.4)	20.0	5.0	5.3
P/E (X)	13.1	11.2	10.7	10.1
P/B (X)	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.1
Price/PPOP (X)	8.0	8.0	7.6	7.2
Dividend yield (%)	4.4	4.6	4.9	5.1
	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS (S\$)	0.85	0.78	0.84	0.82

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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NEUTRAL

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Rating since Nov 9, 2025

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	13.1	11.2	10.7	10.1
Price/PPOP (X)	8.0	8.0	7.6	7.2
P/B (X)	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.1
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	4.4	4.6	4.9	5.1
Div. payout ratio (%)	55.7	50.0	50.0	50.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
BVPS growth	4.1	4.7	5.9	5.6
Total revenue growth	(3.4)	0.7	4.6	4.6
Op. profit growth	(6.9)	0.3	5.5	5.0
Net inc growth	(22.6)	19.5	4.9	5.2
EPS growth	(22.4)	20.0	5.0	5.3
DPS growth	(32.2)	8.8	4.9	5.2

Asset Quality

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.6	0.3	0.3	0.3
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.5	1.6	1.7	1.6
NPL ratio (%)	1.5	1.6	1.7	1.6
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.2	1.3	1.3	1.4
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	24.3	30.8	34.6	35.8
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	80.0	78.3	79.0	83.3

Capital Item

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	16.1	16.1	16.5	16.8

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 7 May 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net interest income	9,355.0	9,339.6	9,596.4	9,925.6
Net fees	2,569.0	2,690.1	2,982.8	3,273.3
Treasury income	1,367.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	518.0	1,872.0	1,965.6	2,008.2
Total revenue	13,809.0	13,901.7	14,544.9	15,207.1
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,414.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(2,744.0)	(6,225.7)	(6,443.6)	(6,701.4)
Pre-provision op. profit	7,651.0	7,675.9	8,101.2	8,505.8
Provision for loans	(1,880.0)	(1,033.1)	(1,101.2)	(1,138.9)
Total provision expense	(2,043.0)	(1,005.1)	(1,101.2)	(1,138.9)
Income/(loss) from associates	79.0	86.9	89.5	92.2
Pre-tax profit	5,656.0	6,756.8	7,089.5	7,459.1
Provision for taxes	(962.0)	(1,148.7)	(1,205.2)	(1,268.0)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	4,681.0	5,593.1	5,869.3	6,176.0
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	4,562.7	5,474.8	5,750.9	6,057.7
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	2.80	3.39	3.56	3.75
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	2.73	3.27	3.44	3.62
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,672.3	1,672.3	1,672.3	1,672.3
Avg. yield on loans (%)	4.4	3.8	3.6	3.5
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	3.9	3.4	3.2	3.0
Cost of fund (%)	2.3	1.8	1.6	1.5
Net interest margin (%)	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.7

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Domestic mortgages	84,962.0	86,881.2	90,232.7	94,783.6
Domestic non-mortgages	30,595.0	31,286.1	32,493.0	34,131.8
Domestic commercial lending	216,502.0	221,392.4	229,932.9	241,529.7
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	352,180.0	360,135.2	374,027.8	392,892.1
Total NPLs, gross	5,379.0	5,860.6	6,273.7	6,393.7
Total loan loss reserve	4,303.0	4,588.8	4,955.8	5,327.8
Net customer loans & advances	347,877.0	355,546.4	369,071.9	387,564.3
Other interest earning assets	106,769.0	109,100.1	111,595.1	114,180.9
Interest earning assets	540,967.0	560,756.8	585,582.6	610,846.9
Other non-int. earning assets	31,094.0	31,088.7	31,012.5	30,942.2
Total assets	572,061.0	591,845.4	616,595.1	641,789.1
Risk weighted assets	275,990.0	286,999.7	299,001.4	311,218.5
CASA deposits	248,620.0	273,482.0	296,819.9	320,565.5
Non-CASA deposits	177,318.0	170,807.9	169,245.5	167,698.7
Customer deposits	425,938.0	444,289.9	466,065.4	488,264.2
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	18,722.0	18,722.0	18,722.0	18,722.0
Total liabilities	520,568.0	538,824.2	560,599.7	582,798.5
Total shareholders' equity	51,493.0	53,021.3	55,995.4	58,990.7
Total liabilities & equity	572,061.0	591,845.4	616,595.1	641,789.1
BVPS (\$\$)	29.00	30.35	32.15	33.96
RWA/assets (%)	48.2	48.5	48.5	48.5

Profit Drivers

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net customer loan growth (%)	4.2	2.2	3.8	5.0
Net interest margin (%)	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.7
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	44.4	44.8	44.3	44.1
Tax rate (%)	17.0	17.0	17.0	17.0
CASA ratio (%)	58.4	61.6	63.7	65.7
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	81.7	80.0	79.2	79.4

Profitability

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.5	2.4	2.4	2.4
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.4
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.2
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.0	1.2	1.2	1.2
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	0.8	1.0	1.0	1.0
Leverage (X)	11.1	11.2	11.0	10.9
ROE (%)	9.6	11.1	11.2	11.1
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	9.2	10.7	10.8	10.7

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

3 key takeaways from the briefing:

- **Asset quality – improving, though investors still want reassurance.** Asset quality remains broadly stable, but has been an area investors are most focused on. For UOB, credit quality has long been the primary weakness given its CRE exposure. This quarter we see the presence of another CRE-related issue which likely means that we still need to monitor for another few quarters though the risk is now less with HK CRE recovering. Overall credit costs came in at **26bps**, comfortably within FY26 guidance of **25–30bps**, which should provide some near-term comfort. In Greater China, NPA formation increased **15% qoq**, driven mainly by CRE, with the NPL ratio rising **20bps qoq to 3.5%** and GP coverage declining to **1.9%**. Management's repeated emphasis that incremental NPAs remain well collateralised helps, but this is an area where investors will continue to watch the details closely. That said, it is worth stressing that **Hong Kong CRE conditions are already improving** and markets would clearly prefer not to see further CRE incidents from here. Outside Greater China, asset-quality trends were more encouraging. In the US, the NPL ratio improved meaningfully to **1.5% from 3.0% in 4Q25**, while NPA coverage more than doubled to **233%**, helping to offset some investor concerns elsewhere. Stepping back, our sense is that while this quarter does not fully clear the slate, it does support the view that UOB is nearing the tail end of its CRE overhang. For confidence to return decisively at a stock level, however, investors will still want to see a few consecutive "clean" quarters with no additional CRE downgrades. In that sense, market anxiety should ease from here, but it has not disappeared altogether. Beyond CRE, we are also starting to see more investor focus on whether UOB has fully captured the second-order impact of the Middle East conflict in its **macroeconomic variables (MEVs)**. Management acknowledged that MEV assumptions were somewhat revised in 1Q26, but noted these would be further looked at in coming quarters. This introduces some uncertainty around forward-looking ECL, particularly into 2Q. Overall, while asset-quality risks should gradually fade as a dominant equity concern, we think they remain a background issue until UOB establishes a clearer clean run-rate. To factor in the lower 1Q26 print, we revise down our FY26 credit cost forecast to 28bps (prior: 32bps).
- **Wealth – long-term ambition clear, but execution still needs to catch up.** Wealth continues to be one of the key growth engines for banks in this region, and management reiterated an ambition to **double wealth income by 2030**, using **2025 as the base year**. This is the right strategic direction and a positive one to drive earnings which aligns with how investors are increasingly valuing banks across Asia – favouring more capital-light, fee-driven businesses. That said, this quarter's wealth performance was **disappointing relative to peers**. Gross wealth fee income grew by 3%, and wealth income by 6%, which pales in comparison to peers delivering **~20%+ growth**. Management acknowledged the softer run-rate, pointing to initiatives that will begin to show through from **2H26**, including a refreshed customer value proposition, strengthened advisory capabilities, broader product offerings, an expanded RM base, and deeper cross-selling across the wealth continuum. With an **8.5m customer base**, the opportunity set is clearly there. For now, however, execution risk remains. With net fee income down **8% YoY** this quarter and

momentum expected to pick up only in the second half, we find it difficult to underwrite high-single-digit growth for 2026 and hence **forecast net fee growth of 5%**. Investors will want clearer milestones and more tangible evidence of re-acceleration before paying up for the wealth story. Given how well peers are executing, this will be an area the market watches closely, and where the stock's performance could meaningfully diverge if momentum improves. We view UOB's ambition to scale its wealth platform positively, underpinned by the structural theme of rising Asian liquidity, which is increasingly driving earnings for Singapore banks and shifting business models towards more capital-light, higher ROE segments (see: Riding Asia's liquidity wave; the earnings engine of HK/SG Banks, 12 Dec 2025).

- **NII / NIM – balancing discipline with delivery.** Management continues to focus on striking the right balance between **preserving NIM** and **delivering NII**, and in this respect 1Q26 was a reasonably good outcome. UOB maintained its FY26 NIM guidance of 1.75–1.80%, supported by expectations of one further Fed cut and limited additional downside from SORA, given a more muted pass-through than in past cycles. Exit NIM for 1Q26 came in at **1.83%**, with quarterly compression limited to just **2bps QoQ**, which better than market fears. Looking ahead, management indicated it remains **opportunistic on funding-cost actions**, depending on the competitive and rate environment. At the same time, UOB reiterated its intent to continue growing deposits, while being cautious about rapidly expanding the balance sheet. Management was clear on the risks associated with deploying excess liquidity into investment securities—particularly **duration and FX risks**—which explains its more conservative approach relative to some peers. We understand this discipline and risk appetite, especially given UOB's strong liquidity position and focus on balance-sheet resilience. With rates appearing more stable in our view, we see scope for **NIM to hold around current levels**, and for **NII to remain broadly stable**. That said, the market will watch closely how effectively management translates this balance-sheet strength into earnings delivery if surplus liquidity conditions persist.

Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed rate cuts; (-) Unexpected deterioration in asset quality; (+) Stronger than expected growth in fee income

Exhibit 1: 1Q26 earnings summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q26E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	2,409	2,336	2,265	2,345	2,324	(4)	(1)	2,327	(0)
Fee & Commission	694	636	615	624	637	(8)	2	756	(16)
Other Non-Interest Income	554	493	518	320	462	(17)	44	506	(9)
Non-Interest Income	1,248	1,129	1,133	944	1,099	(12)	16	1,262	(13)
Operating Income	3,657	3,465	3,398	3,289	3,422	(6)	4	3,589	(5)
Operating Expenses	(1,559)	(1,536)	(1,535)	(1,528)	(1,523)	(2)	(0)	(1,582)	(4)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,098	1,929	1,863	1,761	1,899	(9)	8	2,007	(5)
Loan Loss Provisions	(290)	(279)	(1,361)	(113)	(203)	(30)	80	(300)	(32)
Pre-tax Profit	1,822	1,638	520	1,676	1,712	(6)	2	1,729	(1)
Net Profit	1,490	1,338	443	1,410	1,437	(4)	2	1,431	0
Balance sheet (\$\$mn)									
Assets	538,009	537,838	555,419	572,061	574,233	7	0	579,591	(1)
Gross Loans	341,154	342,900	351,084	352,180	353,837	3.7	0.5	354,169	(0)
Non-Performing Loans	5,458	5,341	5,617	5,379	5,308	(3)	(1)	5,524	(4)
Customer Deposits	401,250	405,076	419,660	425,938	426,731	6	0	432,391	(1)
CAMEL Ratios (%)									
Core Tier 1	15.4	15.1	14.5	14.9	15.2			15.2	
NPL Ratio	1.60	1.56	1.60	1.53	1.50			1.56	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	34	33	157	13	23			34	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.00	1.91	1.82	1.84	1.82			1.79	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	42.6	44.3	45.2	46.5	44.5			44.1	
Loan-to-Deposits	85.0	84.7	83.7	82.7	82.9			81.9	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Melissa Kuang, CFA and Wayne Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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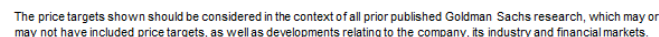
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Date of report	Target price (\$\$)	Closing price (\$\$)
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15-Apr-26	41.50	37.59
26-Mar-26	39.50	36.68
13-Jan-26	40.70	36.19
09-Nov-25	38.00	33.86
29-Oct-25	42.10	34.90
07-Aug-25	42.70	35.81
21-Jul-25	44.70	37.10
18-May-25	45.30	35.50
09-Apr-25	41.90	30.99
09-Mar-25	47.70	38.63
19-Feb-25	46.00	38.58
16-Dec-24	43.60	37.20
10-Nov-24	41.00	35.69
01-Sep-24	35.10	31.39
01-Aug-24	34.50	32.04
08-May-24	33.90	29.88
15-Apr-24	33.80	29.57
23-Feb-24	32.00	28.25
09-Jan-24	32.20	28.51
26-Oct-23	33.40	27.28
18-Oct-23	33.70	28.10
27-Jul-23	32.70	28.92
18-Jul-23	32.10	27.69

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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